

You can cascade or tile web pages to view and there are voice commands and text-reading provisions packed in. All in all, Opera is a browser that has very little to make you want to complain.

What's Awesome

Speed Dial: Open a new tab in Opera and it shows you a thumbnail view of nine of your favourite Web sites, which you can customise. A single click on any one of them quickly gets you to the site and saves you the trouble of having to type the URL into the locator bar. This feature is available as an add-on to Firefox (Fast Dial) and is built into Chrome.

Widgets: Opera offers an incredible variety of widgets – little GUIs like ‘Pandora’s Radio’, ‘Opera.fm’, ‘Artist’s Sketchbook’, Opereach, etc. Just with a couple of clicks, you can access your favourite widget and simultaneously continue with the windows you’re working on.

Faster Page Loading: The tabs open much faster than previous versions of Opera and outdo Firefox, and occasionally even Internet Explorer. Evidently, using Presto as the layout engine seems to have helped to score over Firefox (Gecko) and IE (Trident).

Customisable: Opera has a rich database of skins to make the browser look different. You can arrange toolbars, buttons and panels any way you please and, in short, make it your very own personal browser.

Mouse Gestures: Opera is designed so as to be sensitive to the movement of the mouse, so if you simply move the cursor over the tabs that are open, it instantly shows you a thumbnail preview of the site you have opened. This feature exists as the Cooliris Preview in Mozilla Firefox, but that’s an add-on, while this is integrated into the browser itself.

Native BitTorrent support: BitTorrent is a peer to peer downloading protocol capable of really high performance, over a network of peers using the client. While using Opera, instead of depending on third party clients like BitComet, simply click on a torrent and Opera, which has the feature already integrated in it, will do the rest. However, the feature only supports the BitTorrent exchange protocol and is not intended to replace third-party clients.

What's Awful

Not Open Source: Seeing the immense benefits of community-developed software and browser’s like Firefox, it’s a pity that Opera isn’t yet open source.

Erratic: Opera is sometimes really quick, but often lags behind in navigation time when compared to Firefox and Internet Explorer. Its average startup time is also at least two seconds behind Internet Explore and Chrome.



Google Chrome

So, maybe the logo looks like a Pokeball with the trademark Google colours, but that doesn’t make the browser any less exciting. Using the WebKit rendering engine, Google’s foray into browser land scores really high on our list. It is fast, easy to use, simple and also looks great. Powerful and effective, here’s a browser that finally allows you to use almost the entire screen to view a Web site instead of searching for the site among the toolbars and sidebars of Flock, Opera, etc.

What's Awesome

Tabs on Top: Google has learnt fast and picked up from other browsers most of the features that a good browser should have. One of these is Tabbed Browsing and, like the rest of the engines we’re covering, you can juggle the tabs around and regroup them by dragging and dropping. The cool thing about Chrome’s tabs is that while you’re shifting a tab from one position to another, you can actually see the thumbnail of the site you’re moving being dragged along with the cursor of the mouse. A masterstroke is the moving of all tabs to the top of the screen, a move that has been universally praised by users and critics alike.

Speed: Every tab runs independently. So if one fails, the others aren’t affected. This is a common complaint in other browsers because



then the entire browser closes down when even one tab crashes. Chrome fixes this by running tabs as separate processes. Its navigation time is by far the best and in an age of impatience, Chrome should become everybody’s favourite quite soon.

Universal Bar: The Locator bar on top is not just that – it’s a search bar, a history viewer and an address bar all rolled into one. So as you type, Chrome gives you suggestions from sites you have visited or simply searches (using Google, obviously) for the text you have typed in.

Task Manager: Right-click on the ribbon above and you’ll see the ‘Task Manager’ in the menu that appears. Click on the Task Manager and Chrome will show you exactly how much memory each of your tabs are currently using, allowing you to close tabs that are hogging the CPU’s memory.

Secure: Having each tab run independently lets Chrome detect malware and automatically

pause the opening of a particular tab, while flashing a warning.

Download Manager: Google has shifted the Download Manager to the bottom of the screen. Other browsers have intrusive windows appearing to notify download status: IE, Opera and Firefox download warnings appear in the middle of the screen, but Chrome simply shifts it to the bottom, allowing the user to get on with other more important things.

Private Browsing: Chrome’s ‘Incognito window’ facility allows you to open any webpage without leaving a trace – that is deleting all the cookies, history, etc. This makes the browsing experience safer.

What's Awful

Add-ons: Being a recent entrant, there are almost no add-ons for Google Chrome. However, since it’s open source, you can expect many to start appearing soon.

Digitization Management

You got Yours?

SmartOffice PS286

Mobile Office M12 Plus

Mobile Office 821

Mobile Office 611

Secure Everything IPcam P1100

Knowledge Office OB4600

Document Office PL7500

Document Office A320

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